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Homework 2: Learning Styles

Learning styles affect how we learn because everyone understands and remembers information in different ways. Some people learn best by hearing information, while others need to see it or physically interact with it. Learning styles are more about our personal preferences than a proven way of determining how we learn best. People may prefer to learn in different ways, but research does not show that matching a person's learning style with a specific teaching method necessarily leads to better results. I found it interesting that nearly 70% of the students in the study did not use study methods that matched their reported learning preferences, and the students who did match their strategies to their preferences did not perform better.

The three learning styles discussed are auditory, visual, and tactile. Auditory learners may prefer listening to lectures or discussing information. Visual learners may prefer diagrams, pictures, videos, or written information. Tactile learners may prefer hands-on activities and learning by doing. I think most people can benefit from all three approaches rather than limiting themselves to one style.

How we study may matter more than identifying our learning style. For me, this means that instead of saying, "I am a visual learner, so I need pictures," it is better to ask, "What will actually help me understand and remember this information?" The learning style you align yourself with provides a great baseline for you to understand what may work for you to retain information; however, confining yourself to one specific style seems to have no benefit. Doing things like spacing out study sessions, testing ourselves, using multiple ways to experience information, and making meaningful connections can help us learn more effectively. Learning preferences can be useful for making learning more comfortable and engaging, but they should not limit how we learn.